



Bahadur Singh Sagoo elected Athletics Federation of India president



Asian Games gold medallist shot-putter and Padma Shri awardee Bahadur Singh Sagoo has been elected as the new president of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) on the opening day of its two-day Annual General Meeting in Chandigarh. Outgoing president Adille Sumariwalla, stepping down after three consecutive terms, announced new events and future plans for the federation.

With no other contenders, Bahadur, who won gold at the 2002 Asian Games, was unanimously elected to succeed Sumariwalla.

Delhi Athletics secretary Sandeep Mehta was elected as the new AFI secretary general, replacing Ravinder Chaudhary. The most significant announcement, however, was the launch of a major javelin competition aimed at fostering and capitalising on the country's growing interest in the sport.

"It will be an invitational event featuring the world's top 10 throwers. Neeraj (Chopra) is also involved in organising it, alongside AFI, JSW, and a foreign firm working together to create this new competition," Sumariwalla revealed.

"It will be held sometime later in the year," he added.

UTHRA GANESAN

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SPORTOON



1 Champions Tamil Nadu and Railways comfortably defended their title in the men's and women's sections, respectively, in the 74th National Basketball Championship at the Sidsar Sports Complex in Bhavnagar, Gujarat. Tamil Nadu men won 80-56 against Punjab after leading 48-26 at halftime. Equally, Railways was assertive in its 86-53 victory over Kerala in the women's final, after leading 46-36 at the interval. The 'Most Valuable Player' awards, with a Maruti WagonR car as a prize, were bagged by Pranav Prince of Tamil Nadu and Dharshini Thirunavukkarasu of Railways.

The champion teams received Rs 5 lakh each, and the runner-up, Rs 3 lakh. Railways men and Tamil Nadu women won third place and collected two lakh rupees each. R. Sreekala of Kerala and Kanwar Gurbaz Singh Sandhu were presented Rs. 50,000 each for their prowess in shooting three-pointers.

The results:

Men (final): Tamil Nadu 80 bt Punjab 56.

Third place: Railways 71 bt Karnataka 50.

Women (final): Railways 86 bt Kerala 53;

Third place: Tamil Nadu 86 bt Delhi 64.

TEAM SPORTSTAR